

U OF M CLUBS

The University of Manitoba Student Guide To Clubs & Communities



Off The Syllabus

Discover what campus life has to offer beyond your classes

Is university just attending classes and worrying about your GPA? Of course not. What makes university more than lectures, assignments and exams is everything happening outside the classroom, and one of the easiest ways to get involved is through clubs.

From study groups and course-related clubs to cultural, religious and recreational groups, there's something for almost every interest. Some clubs are focused on helping you academically, while others are simply a way to have fun, meet people,

explore an interest or give back to the community.

Throughout the academic year, clubs host all kinds of events, workshops and activities. They tend to be especially active during the fall and winter terms, although some continue to organize events during the

summer as well.

University can get exhausting when it feels like you're constantly studying. Sometimes, stepping away from your coursework and doing something you genuinely enjoy is exactly what you need.

There's a club for that²

Explore student groups built around every kind of interest

New here? Start here⁴

Everything you need to know before joining your first club

Make the most of it⁶

Friends and memories that last beyond graduation

Clubs

What's your niche?

Meet people who share your interests



SOMI

University of Manitoba Student-Organized Market Initiative (SOMI) is a community of student entrepreneurs, makers, and supporters aiming to create accessible spaces for student businesses to start and grow! SOMI supports student-owned businesses by providing them opportunities to table at markets. Aside from campus markets, they also host crafty workshops and other fun, social events for our general members.

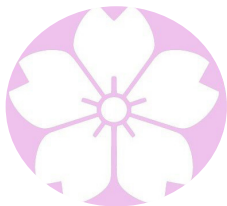


UM Book Society

UMBS provides an inclusive environment for book lovers and story seekers of all backgrounds to gather and talk about books and other forms of storytelling. UMBS aims to hold regular programming and social events catered to a wide audience, as well as providing members with opportunities to explore meaningful stories and shared lived experiences.

UM Dairy Club

UMDC aims to improve and promote the dairy industry through educational events, fundraising, community service, and more club activities. They partner with the U of M Dairy Science Pilot Plant where student volunteers can learn how to make dairy products!



UM Anime

UM Anime club provides a safe and inclusive space to anime enjoyers of all kinds. They have a history of holding all sorts of events! From Gunpla building sessions, Beyblade tournaments, screening events and ink brush drawing sessions to big events like ice-breakers, Butler/Maid cafes and more!



Parks Club

UMPC brings together youth from across Canada to experience, appreciate, protect, and promote Canada's natural and cultural heritage. Through monthly outdoor adventures such as hiking, camping, and other group activities, they inspire students to connect with nature, build outdoor skills, and form lasting friendships.



Matcha Club

The purpose of UM Matcha club is to create a welcoming community for students and matcha enthusiasts. Their goals are to deepen the community's knowledge and love for matcha, share tips and guidance, host interactive workshops, and collaborate with local cafés to bring the matcha experience to more people.



Esports Club

The University of Manitoba Esports club is a student-led group passionate about all things gaming. They work with industry leaders and Esports leagues to create both competitive and casual gaming events. They also host Esports teams for popular titles such as Super Smash Bros, Valorant and League of Legends.



UM Snow

UMSNOW is a club that offers the opportunity to get university students out to Western Canada to ski. They organize events and an annual ski trip during winter reading week.



Chess Club

The mission of the Chess Club is to provide a relaxed and social environment for players of all levels to gather and play chess. They hold regular sessions, tournaments, as well as social events away from the board.



Course related clubs

Microbiology Student Club



MiSC is dedicated to building community among undergraduate students interested in microbiology, genetics, and biochemistry. They provide opportunities for academic support, professional development, and social connection through events, workshops, and networking opportunities.

U of M Undergraduate Leaders in Healthcare



UM-ULH exists to bring together students interested in healthcare, to learn more about their fields of interest, to discuss current topics in Canadian Healthcare, and to serve as a platform for interdisciplinary networking with professionals within the healthcare field.

UM Finance Organization



UMFO aims to lower entry barriers into the finance industry. They are committed to enriching students' and partners' experiences through networking events, information sessions, and immersive finance world experiences, preparing students for successful careers.



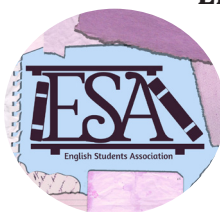
Spanish Club

A vibrant and welcoming space designed especially for students enrolled in Spanish courses, offering them a unique opportunity to deepen their understanding of the Hispanic language and culture while connecting with others who share the same interest. At the heart of the club lies its dedication to representing the diverse Hispanic community on campus, providing a meaningful platform where its rich traditions, cultures, and values can be proudly showcased and celebrated by all.

Student Associations

Groups representing students within a faculty

English Students Association



A club dedicated to fostering community and opportunities for those interested in literature and English Students at the University of Manitoba. They host events, student-run literature zine, movie, study, and craft nights!

UM Engineering Society

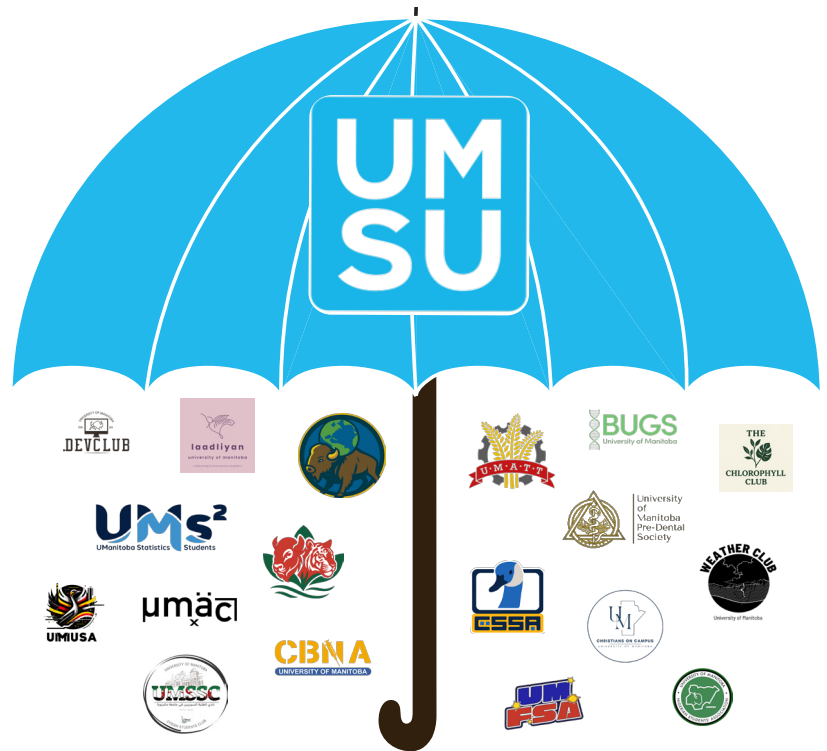


UMES is the main student group for engineering students at U of M. It serves as a representative of the students to the Faculty, University, and other engineering schools across the country. UMES also puts on a number of social, academic, professional development, and networking events throughout the year.

These are just a few of the clubs, the full list of clubs can be found on the UMSU website.

Is UMSU a club too?

UMSU stands for the *U of M Students' Union*, the representative student body established under its own provincial law, the UMSU Act. It recognizes and supports over 150 clubs and student associations while focusing on academic advocacy, enhancing student experiences and fostering a vibrant campus culture. Therefore, it's **not** a club, but the Students' Union that represents undergraduate students and provides services and support to clubs.



Ready to join?

Here's the step-by-step guide

1. Pick a club. Or two!

All clubs are listed on the UMSU website with a brief description of what they're about. Find something that piques your interest and check out their Instagram page. You can also walk around campus and look out for posters. Bulletin boards are always full of them, and posters are regularly displayed on TVs around campus. See something that catches your eye? Look it up and get involved!

3. *Stalker mode: ON*

Scroll through their Instagram and check out past events, workshops, activities and more to learn about the club. Follow their page while you're there so you don't miss out on future announcements.

2. Link hopping

Once on their Instagram, check the bio for links. Most clubs use a Linktree, where you'll usually find their membership form. Fill it out to become a member. Many clubs also have a Discord server or Telegram group as their main form of communication. As a member, you'll have access to these and can stay up to date with upcoming activities and announcements.

4. *The fun part*

When you spot an upcoming event, whether through Instagram, a poster around campus or the club's Discord, check whether an RSVP is required and sign up if needed. Otherwise, just show up! From games and snacks to workshops and educational events, there's plenty to get involved in. Mingle with other members, meet the executive team, make friends and start making your own campus memories.



Beyond membership

There's more to joining a club than filling out a membership form and attending events. You can also be a part of the team that runs the club and organizes its activities by joining the executive team or occasionally helping out as a volunteer. Both roles are meaningful ways to contribute to campus life.

Executive Team

Executive teams consist of Directors, Presidents, Vice Presidents and Associates, all of which can offer valuable hands-on experience. However, the descriptions of these roles may vary from club to club. If you're interested in joining a club's executive team, keep an eye out for their hiring posts, which explain the responsibilities and requirements of each position so you can see which role is right for you. The application process is generally straightforward and often includes an interview.

Volunteer

Volunteers help with event set-up, teardown, registration, food distribution and other event-day tasks. Similar to the executive roles, volunteer opportunities also differ for every club, so check their Instagram or other communication channels for announcements and details. If you don't have much time to spare, this is a great way to get involved and help out at events, while also adding to your experience record.

Clubs

What are the benefits?

More friends, more experiences, more opportunities.

The best thing about clubs are the people you otherwise would have most likely never met. People from all walks of life can share the same interests as you and be in the same club. Especially at the University of Manitoba, with its high enrolment of international students, you get to meet people from various cultures and backgrounds.

Clubs can also help you discover new interests. Never tried hiking before? The UM Parks Club might have

something in store for you. Clubs are also not just for first-years trying to make friends. On the contrary, executive teams are usually made up of students from their second, third or fourth years. Not only are you expanding your circle of friends, but you are also building your network.

Although being a club executive can be time-consuming, it can be a highly rewarding experience. The feeling of joy from planning and executing a successful

event is extraordinary, but you also learn along the way. How to communicate, plan meetings and agendas, lead a team and manage a budget are all skills that can be useful beyond university.

Moreover, subject-based clubs can help you explore different career paths, and if you already have a career in mind, faculty-based associations can help you immensely. The most important thing of all is to have fun and make your university years some of

the best times of your life.

"I wish I had joined more clubs in my first and second years. Now I'm in my fourth year, busy with co-op and studies and regretting it"

— Rabeya Hossain, Asper School of Business

